

# Snowdrop

## Textual Questions

### **Q1. How has nature shrunk the globe?**

Ans. Nature has shrunk the globe by the toughness and brutality that a severe winter brings. It has restricted the movement of all animals. They no longer scurry or fly as they used to. Winter has reduced their horizon. They live in the fear of death.

### **Q2. What has dulled the mouse's heart?**

Ans: It is the severe winter that has dulled the mouse's heart. The mouse is generally a very lively creature. It remains very alert but now due to the intense cold, it is feeling dull at heart. All its activities have come to an end.

### **Q3. What sufferings do the animals undergo in the poem?**

Ans. Animals feel very dull in winter. All their sportiveness comes to an end. They find no place of shelter. They see death all around them. They remain in the fear that death could come to them any time. They seem to have been molded in brass.

### **Q4. Write a short note of 50-100 words on Hughes' view of nature.**

Ans. Hughes' attitude to nature distinguishes him from almost all other poets. He presents nature as very cruel and heartless. It remains indifferent to the sufferings of poor little creatures. It goes on with its deadly course without caring what happens to them. It takes away their sportiveness and makes them dull. But by giving the example of snowdrop, the poet gives a message also. In nature, only those will survive who have the courage and determination to continue to live. The snowdrop pushes its stem up even through the thick layers of snow. Thus it is able to bloom even in the intense cold.

### **Q5. 'Her pale head heavy as metal'. Explain.**

Ans: Here the poet refers to the snowdrop flower. Its head is quite heavy. It keeps hanging down. It seems to be made of heavy metal. But this heaviness and hardness of head is the secret of its strength. It is the secret of its survival even in the intense cold. This strength enables it to push its stem even through the thick layers of snow. Thus, to the poet, the snowdrop is a symbol of the survival of the fittest in nature.

### **Q7. 'Weasel and crow, as if molded in brass'. Explain the simile used by the poet.**

Ans: The simile expresses the brutality of winter. The bitter cold has restricted the movement of weasel and crow. They have lost their usual sportiveness. They are frozen with cold. This frozen stillness of a weasel and a crow has been compared to brass.

**Trace two lines in which 'ou' sound is used. Also write down the words with 'ou' sound**

Ans. The two lines having 'ou' sound are

i) Round the mouse's dulled wintering heart.

(ii) Move through an outer darkness,

Words with the 'ou' sound are: round, mouse, outer.